

Policy for Provision of Counselling Services at GIMS

1. Purpose

This initiative is envisioned as a safe, compassionate space where students can feel heard, supported, and understood- without fear of judgment. In today's environment, mental well-being is not just important but essential. Students are bearing not only academic demands but also personal, social, and emotional challenges. When mental health is neglected, it often shows up in the form of academic burnout, isolation, or lack of motivation.

By creating an open and stigma-free environment, this cell aims to *raise awareness, encourage early support-seeking behaviour, and promote emotional resilience* through non-clinical, confidential guidance offered by trained counsellors.

We strongly believe that when students are mentally well, they are more likely to thrive in all aspects of campus life- academics, communication, confidence, leadership, and relationships. Supporting mental health doesn't just help individuals, but lifts the entire learning environment. In a management college, where students are being shaped into future leaders, decision-makers, and professionals, it is vital to ensure that they are not just academically competent, but also emotionally resilient, self-aware, and mentally well-equipped.

It's worth noting that many leading colleges and universities across the country and around the world already have dedicated mental health initiatives or wellness cells in place. Establishing one in our institution isn't just a progressive step, it's a much-needed one, aligning us with best practices in holistic education and student care.

2. Objectives

- To enhance mental health literacy across the campus through psychoeducation, promoting awareness of common psychological issues, help-seeking behaviours, and available support systems.
- To support students in developing core psychological competencies such as emotional regulation, distress tolerance, resilience, self-awareness, and interpersonal effectiveness.
- To implement structured protocols for early detection of trauma, mood and anxiety disorders, and substance use, with appropriate risk assessment and referral to qualified mental health professionals for intervention.
- To provide targeted preventive programs addressing suicide prevention, trauma-informed care, and substance use awareness, using developmentally appropriate and culturally sensitive approaches.

GNIOT INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT STUDIES (GIMS)

Approved by AICTE, Ministry of Education, Govt. of India



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- a. To establish a clear and confidential referral system that ensures timely access to counselling, psychotherapy, psychiatric care, and crisis support, in collaboration with licensed mental health practitioners.

4. Key Functions

A. Counselling Services

- a. **Individual Counselling:** 1-on-1 confidential sessions with a qualified psychologist.
- b. **Group Sessions/Support Circles:** On common student concerns (stress, adjustment, motivation).
- c. **Walk-in Hours:** For brief guidance or emotional support.

B. Referral Network

1. Directory of trusted **clinical psychologists, psychiatrists, helplines**, and NGOs for complex cases.
2. Emergency protocols for suicide ideation, self-harm, or psychiatric crisis.

5. Code of Ethics

Confidentiality: All personal disclosures remain strictly private unless there's a risk to self or others

Non-judgmental Environment: Respect for all identities, opinions, and backgrounds

Voluntary Participation: No coercion in using or offering services

Referral Policy: Only mental health professionals may provide clinical insight; volunteers may refer.

6. Operational Plan

Student Engagement

- Students may self-refer or be referred by faculty/staff for counselling.
- Publicize the availability of guidance and counselling services via notice boards/email.
- Provide clear information on how to book appointments (in-person or online).

Appointment Scheduling

- Maintain a confidential appointment log.
- Offer flexible appointment slots to accommodate student schedules.

Initial Assessment



- Conduct an initial intake session to understand the student's concerns and needs.
- Explain confidentiality and its limits (e.g., risk of harm, substance abuse, etc).
- Discuss the counselling process and set goals collaboratively.

Counselling Sessions

- Conduct individual, couple, or group counselling as appropriate.
- Use psychological techniques tailored to the student's needs.
- Maintain professional boundaries at all times.
- Keep session notes confidential and secure.

Follow-Up and Referrals

- Schedule follow-up sessions as required.
- Provide crisis intervention or emergency support as needed.

Confidentiality and Privacy

- All student information and session content must be kept strictly confidential.
- Records should be stored securely, accessible only to authorized personnel.
- Exceptions to confidentiality will be communicated clearly to students at the outset.

Documentation and Reporting

- Maintain detailed but confidential counselling records.
- Generate periodic reports on the number of sessions, general issues (anonymized), and outcomes to improve services.
- Ensure compliance with data protection laws and institutional policies.

Emergency Procedures

- Have a clear protocol for handling crisis situations (e.g., suicidal ideation, abuse disclosures).
- Maintain a list of emergency contacts and referral agencies.
- Ensure immediate intervention and support.

Space and Resource Requirements

A dedicated room or private space for one-on-one sessions

Monitoring and Reporting



- Annual review of outcomes, challenges, and recommendations
- Periodic feedback from students, faculty, and professionals

Policy Alignment

The proposed establishment of the Counselling Services at GIMS is aligned with the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020, which emphasizes holistic student development, emotional well-being, and the integration of support systems within educational institutions. Additionally, it upholds the provisions of the Mental Healthcare Act (MHCA) 2017, by promoting the right to dignified, non-discriminatory, and confidential mental healthcare - ensuring that students facing psychological challenges receive timely, ethical, and stigma-free support.

By institutionalizing this initiative, GNIOT Institute of Management Studies (GIMS) will set itself apart from the vast majority of management colleges in India that lack a formal mental health support system. This will not only enhance student well-being and academic performance but also position the college as a progressive, student-centric institution that meets global standards of higher education and student care.



A handwritten signature in green ink is written over a circular official stamp. The stamp is purple and contains the text "GNIOT Institute of Management Studies" around the perimeter, "GIMS" in the center, and "Greater Noida" at the bottom.